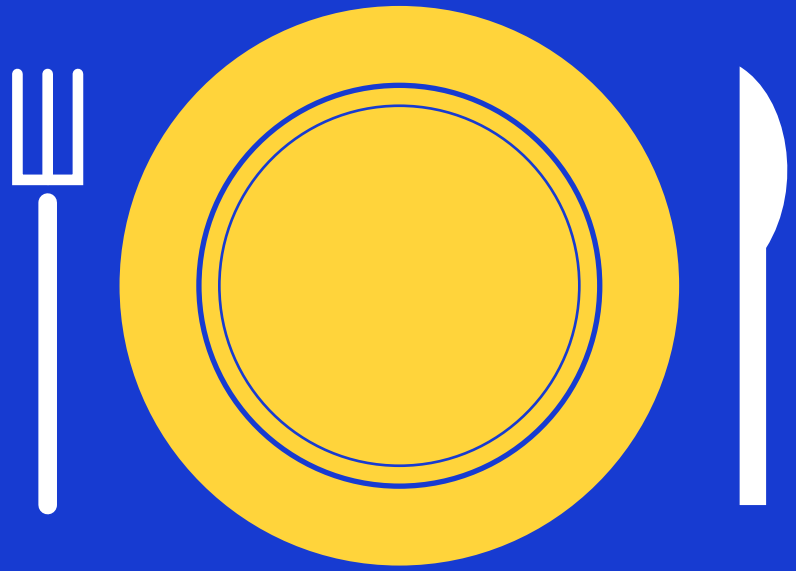
ECONOMICS RESEARCH SEMINAR

RESEARCH SERIES / 2024

Politics on the Menu

Political Identity, Consumer Sorting, and Restaurant Engagement



IDENTITY / CHOICE / EVERYDAY LIFE

Your Name

Department of Economics / Your University

April 12, 2024

01

Motivation

MOTIVATION

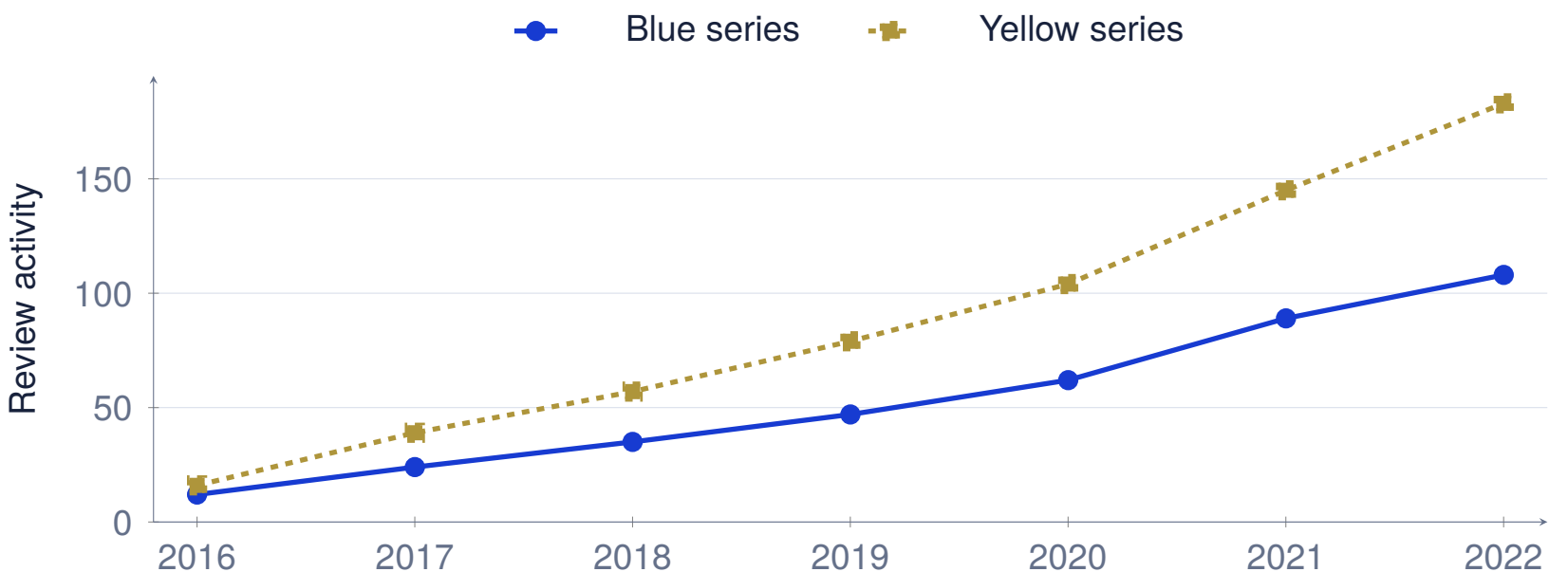
Political identity enters everyday choices

- Political identity may shape where people spend time and money.
- Restaurants provide a social setting beyond explicit politics.
- The study examines choice, engagement, and consumer sorting.

Where people eat provides a setting for studying identity and choice.

MOTIVATION

Two series describe growing review activity



Illustrative series retained from the supplied demo. Units and data provenance were not supplied.

02

Data

DATA

The archive links reviews to restaurant groups

OpenRice review archive

- 2,269,004 eligible reviews.
- 260,911 reviewers.
- 39,199 establishments.
- Research window: 2016–2025.

District-resolved eligible review sample.

Three-color classification

Group	Restaurants
Yellow	3,837
Blue	2,469
White	32,893

Color labels are measurement devices; White does not mean politically neutral.

03

Empirical Strategy

EMPIRICAL STRATEGY

Three comparisons organize the empirical design

1. Compare allocation across fixed restaurant color groups.

2. Match restaurants around first qualifying Yellow reviews.

3. Estimate conditional review choice across the three colors.

The design summary is retained from the supplied demonstration.

04

Results

RESULTS

Report count and rating estimates together

	Count	Rating
Months +1 to +3	0.233***	0.983***
	(0.031)	(0.242)
Months +4 to +6	0.251***	1.289***
	(0.036)	(0.258)
Months +7 to +12	0.192***	1.031***
	(0.042)	(0.243)

Illustrative layout using supplied manuscript estimates. Parenthetical values and stars are preserved verbatim.

Units, inference details, significance thresholds, and full model statistics were not supplied; verify before use.

RESULTS

Early attraction depends on the availability model

- Estimated availability makes early Yellow attraction model-sensitive.
- Availability differs from proportional adjustment.
- The late negative Yellow index persists across specifications.

Model object

Conditional allocation across colors, holding district-quarter activity and recorded restaurant stock fixed.

The reopening-period decline persists in the supplied demonstration.

05

Conclusion

CONCLUSION

Interpret the outcomes that are actually measured

- Sorting, public identity, and business evaluation are distinct.
- Local attention gains can coexist with weaker later attraction.
- The evidence concerns recorded reviews and ratings.

Reviews and ratings do not directly measure tastes, transactions, or welfare.